to send their sons to fight in Central America, and I had no intention of asking them to do that.

Besides, I knew that simply sending our troops into Central America wouldn't end the threat of Communist subversion. There were formidable economic and political problems in many of these countries that made them fertile ground for Castro's revolutionary guerrillas, and these problems had to be dealt with. Millions of people in Latin America lived under terrible conditions of bleak poverty, and close to ninety percent of them lived under governments that were virtual dictatorships. Sure, we could send in the troops, but the threat of Communism wouldn't diminish until the people's standard of living was improved and the totalitarian countries of Latin America gave them more freedom.

Franklin D. Roosevelt, John F. Kennedy, and other American presidents had introduced a variety of plans aimed at dealing with the economic, social, and political imbalances that made Latin America so ripe for revolution, but none had succeeded; the Latin American countries always saw the "Great Colossus" coming down from the north with a blueprint to impose on them against their will.

Yet something had to be done. I asked David Rockefeller to see if he could help develop a plan to improve the economies of the Latin countries that they would not construe as another attempt by the "Great Colossus" to tell them what to do.

In the final analysis, I realized that the problems of Latin America would have to be solved by the Latin American countries themselves, but I had believed for many years (in fact I'd opened my 1980 presidential campaign with a speech on the theme) that the largest countries of North America—Canada, Mexico, and the United States—should forge a closer alliance and become more of a power in the world and help with the problems. Not only would it be to our mutual economic benefit—I thought that working